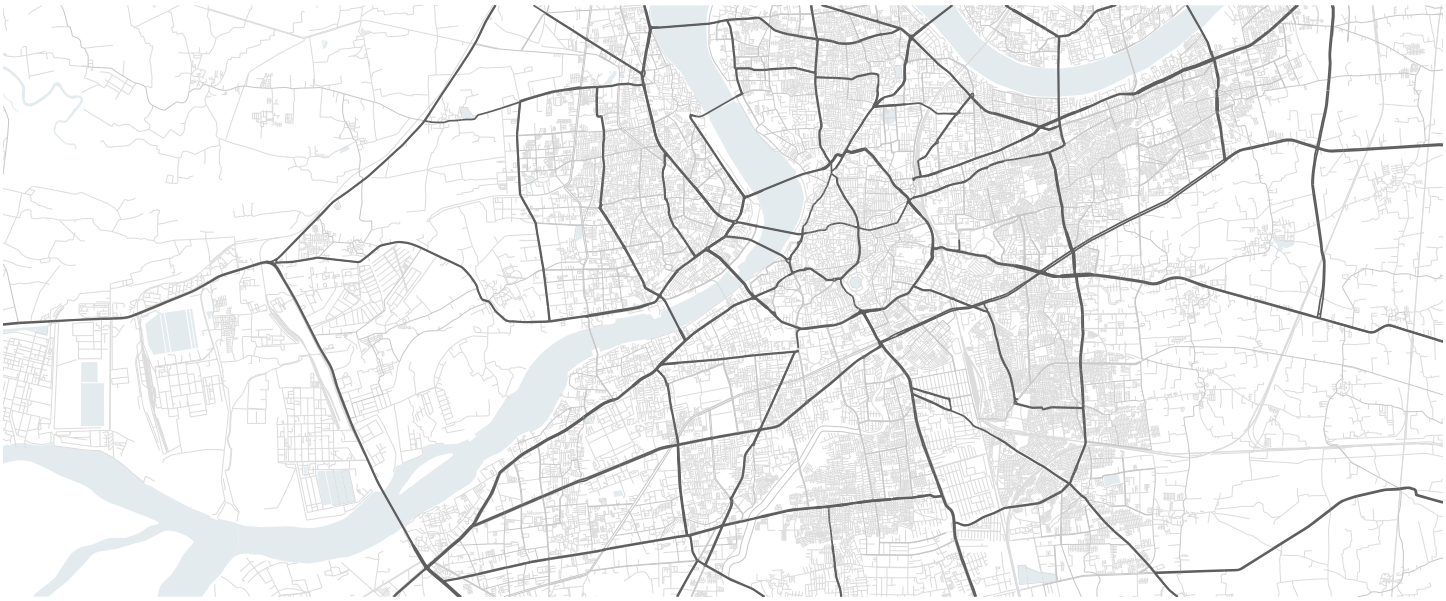
SURAT

GUJARAT INDIA

A PERSONAL CITY BOOK

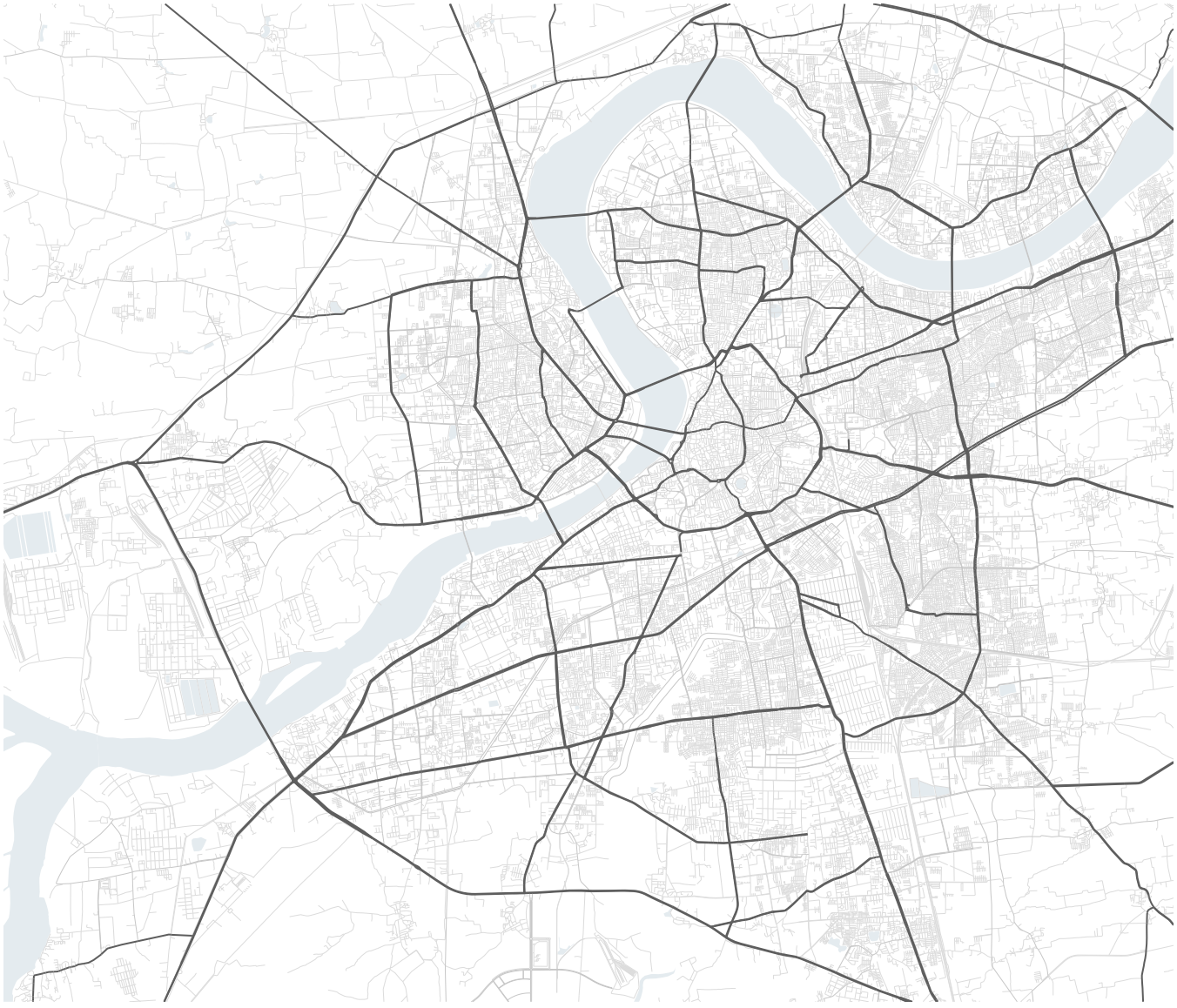


SURAT MUNICIPAL AREA · 1:145 000

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL 1.0

THE TAPI

The Tapi rises near Multai, in Betul district, Madhya Pradesh, and runs about 724 km west to the Gulf of Khambhat. Surat stands on both banks, roughly 20 km upstream of the mouth. Below is the river as OpenStreetMap records it: channel, sandbanks, and the crossings that tie Adajan and Pal to the old city.



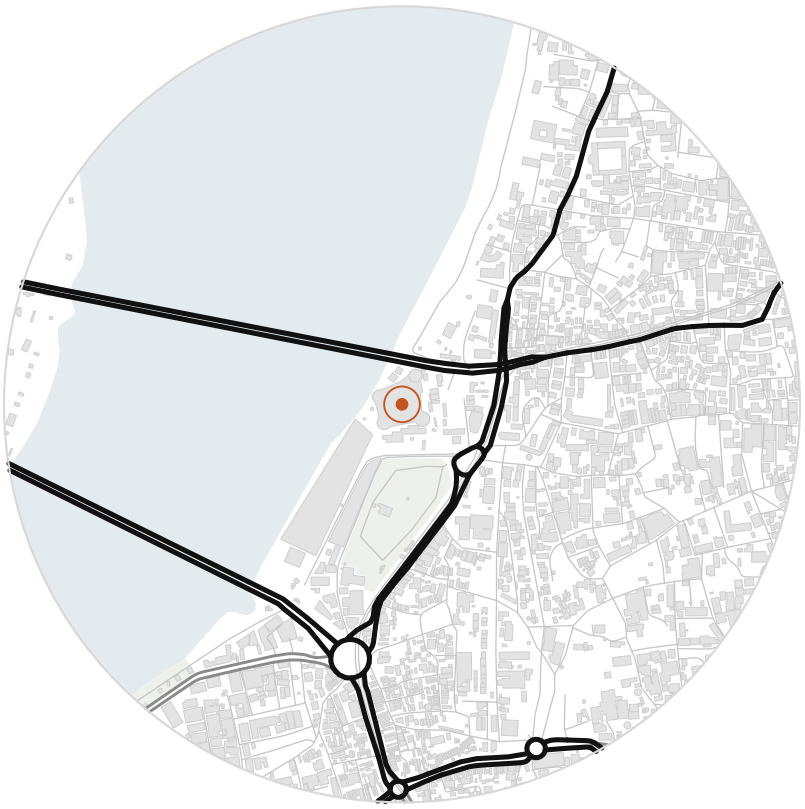
THE TAPI THROUGH SURAT · 1:120 000

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL 1.0

LAYERS OF HISTORY

Surat Castle was built between 1540 and 1546 by Khudawand Khan for Sultan Mahmud Shah III, to hold the river against Portuguese raids. It is a roughly square work of about an acre, with 12.2 m corner bastions and curtain walls 4.1 m thick.

1540–46	Castle built for Sultan Mahmud Shah III
1613	English East India Company opens its first Indian factory
1687	The Company moves its headquarters to Bombay
2015	Conservation passes to the municipal corporation
2022	The castle reopens to the public in September



SURAT CASTLE AND THE OLD CITY · 1:13 500

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL 1.0

DIAMOND CITY

21.1100° N 72.7951° E

BOURSE

9.9 km

DIRECT FROM BANGLE

17 . 12 . 2023

OPENED

Rough stones arrive from Antwerp and Dubai and leave Surat cut and polished. The workshops are concentrated in Varachha, Katargam and Mahidharpura; the trade's usual estimate is that nine in ten of the world's diamonds pass through them. The Surat Diamond Bourse at Khajod opened on 17 December 2023 with about 4,500 offices in nine linked spines.



SURAT DIAMOND BOURSE, KHAJOD · 1:8 000

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL 1.0

THE TEXTILE CITY

Surat weaves, dyes and prints man-made fibre — polyester and viscose — on several hundred thousand power looms, then sells it wholesale from market buildings packed along Ring Road. Industry bodies put the city's daily output in the tens of millions of metres.

MARKET BUILDINGS ON THE RING ROAD

- India
- Raghukul
- Shalimar
- Silk City
- Reshamwala
- Someshwar
- Millennium
- Bombay
- Universal
- Abhinandan
- Swadesi
- New Textile Market



RING ROAD MARKET BLOCKS · 1:12 500

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL 1.0

BANGLE

HOME IN SURAT



21.1990° N
72.7901° E

SURAT, GUJARAT, INDIA

1 km radius · 1:12 000 · Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL 1.0
Rendered from OpenStreetMap geometry in the prettymaps manner

SURTI FLAVOURS

Four dishes ordered by name in Surat and almost nowhere else. Each is described from the plate rather than from a story about its origin.

01

ALOOPURI

Small fried puris under white-pea ragda, potato, sev and green and kokum chutney.

02

LOCHO

Steamed gram-flour batter left deliberately soft, scooped hot with butter, sev, onion and chutney.

03

KHAVSA

Surat's reading of Burmese khow suey: noodles in coconut-milk gravy, finished with crushed papdi, garlic and lime.

04

CHEESE ANGOORI

Grape-sized cheese balls in a creamy onion and tomato gravy, eaten with pav.

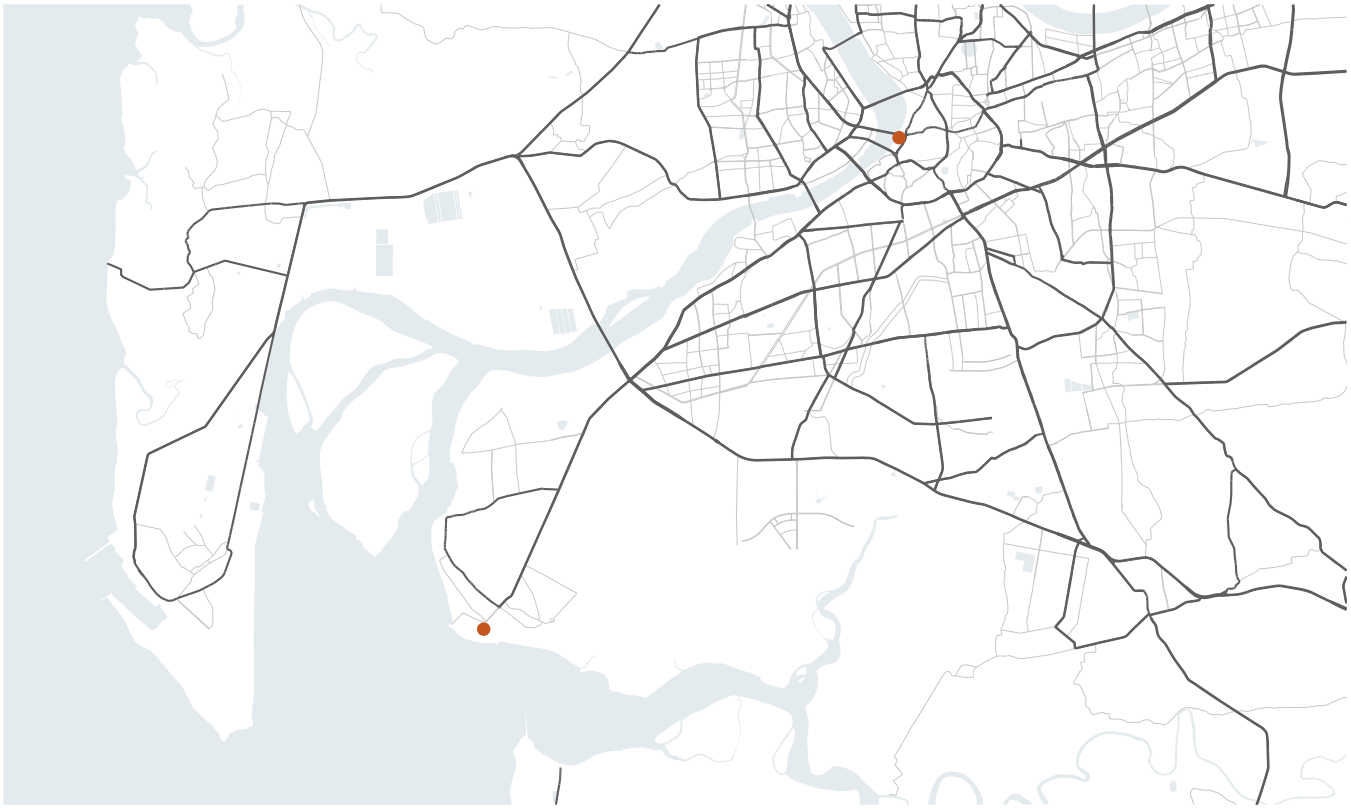
BUSINESSES IN SURAT CARRYING THE DISH IN THEIR NAME, OPENSTREETMAP

21	11	2	1
LOCHO	ALOOPURI	KHAVSA / KHAUSA	CHEESE ANGOORI

This edition carries no photography — see the colophon.

DUMAS

Dumas lies on the Arabian Sea about 21 km south-west of Surat by road, on the south side of the Tapi's mouth. The sand is dark, usually attributed to iron-bearing sediment. Surat airport lies about 5 km inland; the city itself is out of sight.



SURAT TO DUMAS · 1:195 000

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL 1.0

STRAIGHT-LINE DISTANCES, COMPUTED FROM COORDINATES

16.8 km	4.3 km	19.1 km	15.4 km
SURAT CASTLE	SURAT AIRPORT	SURAT JUNCTION	BANGLE

Published road distances: about 21 km from the city, 7 km from the airport, 22 km from Surat Junction.

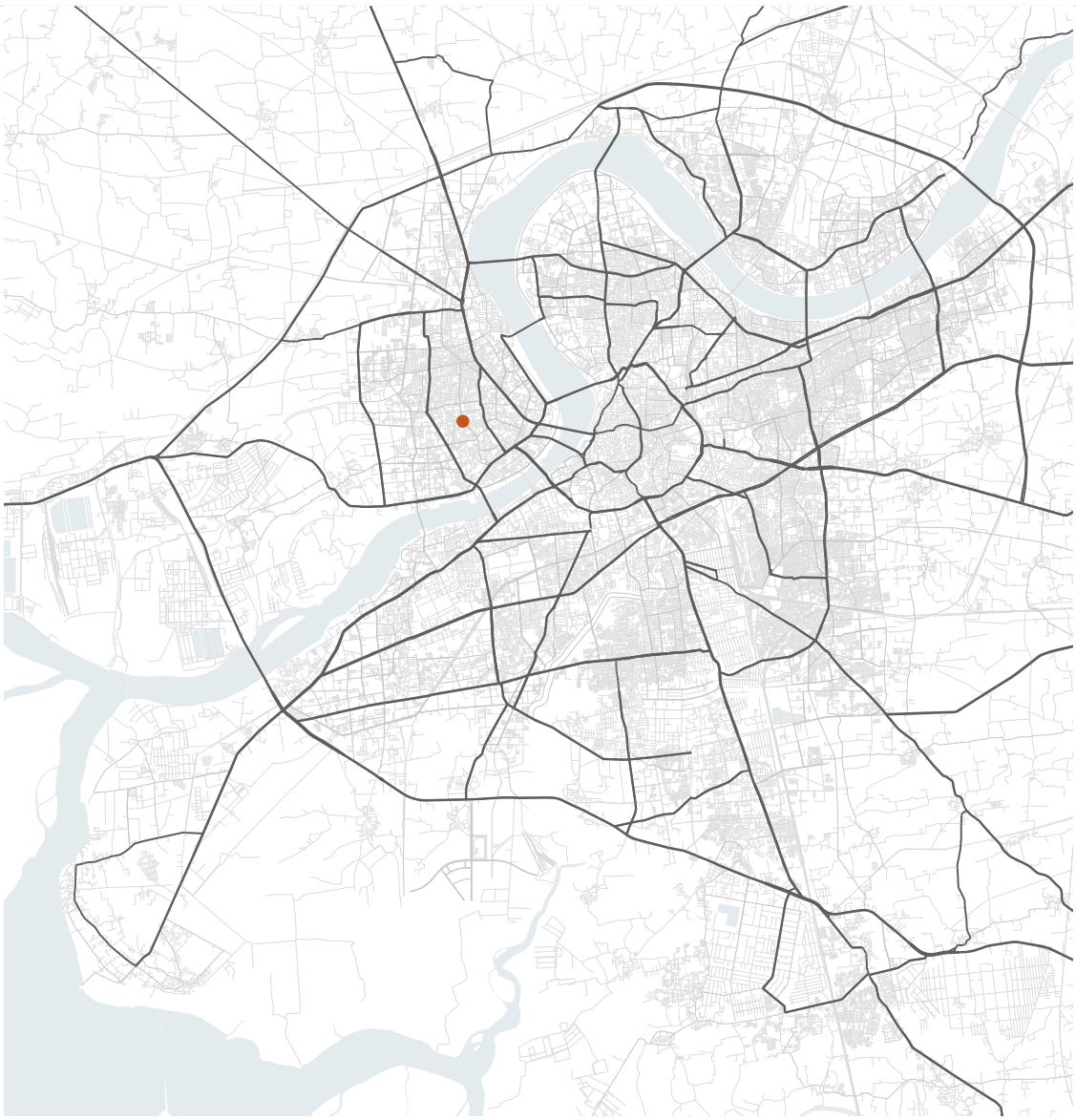
SURAT TODAY

4,467,797
Population, 2011 census

462.1 km²
Municipal area, after the 2020 extension

724 km
The Tapi, source to sea

2 lines
Metro under construction



SURAT STREET NETWORK · 1:165 000

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL 1.0

EVERYDAY SURAT

Four quarters at one scale, 900 metres across. Same city, four grains: the packed lanes behind the castle, the market blocks on Ring Road, the plotted streets of Adajan, the thin edge at Dumas.

Each tile 900 × 900 m · 1:13 000

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors, ODbL 1.0



Old city

Chowk and the castle



Ring Road

Textile market blocks



Adajan

Bangle, off Anand Mahal Road



Dumas

The coast road

SURAT

સુરત

21.1990° N
72.7901° E

CARTOGRAPHY

Every map in this book is drawn from real OpenStreetMap geometry, read from the Overture Maps Foundation's open data release 2026-08-19.0 (transportation, water and land-use themes carry OSM record ids and the ODbL 1.0 licence; building footprints are OSM plus openly licensed machine-derived footprints). Layers were clipped, projected to UTM zone 43N and rendered as vector PDF in the prettymaps manner: white ground, pale grey footprints, graded road hierarchy, one warm marker. No street, building or coastline on these pages was drawn by hand.

MAP ATTRIBUTION

Map data © OpenStreetMap contributors, licensed ODbL 1.0. Geometry distributed by the Overture Maps Foundation. Rendered with GeoPandas and Matplotlib in the manner of prettymaps (github.com/marceloprates/prettymaps); prettymaps itself queries the Overpass API, which was unreachable from the machine that built this book, so its rendering approach was reproduced against the same underlying OpenStreetMap data.

PHOTOGRAPHY

This edition carries no photographs. The build environment's network policy blocked every source of genuinely licensed, print-resolution photography of Surat — Wikimedia Commons, Unsplash, Pexels and government media among them. Rather than fill the pages with synthesised or low-resolution imagery, the layout was changed: the book is set as an atlas, and the city supplies its own pictures in the form of its street geometry.

TYPOGRAPHY

Cormorant Garamond and Inter, both under the SIL Open Font Licence 1.1, with Noto Serif Gujarati for the Gujarati title on the closing page. Numerals are set in Inter throughout: Cormorant Garamond ships old-style figures, which read badly in data. Set in live PDF text at 8.5 × 11 in, with a 0.75 in type margin and nothing closer than 0.42 in to the trim.

FACTUAL SOURCES

· Surat Castle dates, dimensions and 2022 reopening — Surat Municipal Corporation, suratmunicipal.gov.in; Wikipedia, Surat Castle.
· Trading history, 1613 factory and the 1687 move to Bombay — Government of Gujarat NRI division; Wikipedia, Surat Presidency.
· Diamond industry share and Surat Diamond Bourse, opened 17 December 2023 — Wikipedia, Surat Diamond Bourse; trade press.
· Textile output and man-made-fibre share — Fibre2Fashion; Ministry of Textiles, txcindia.gov.in.
· Tapi length and source — India-WRIS; Wikipedia, Tapti River.
· Dumas distances — Gujarat Tourism and surat.nic.in; straight-line figures computed from coordinates in this book.
· Population and municipal area — Surat Municipal Corporation, Census of India 2011.
· Full URLs, licences and the asset manifest are in SOURCES.txt.